

Siri's doppelganger?

Evi, an app for iOS and Android brings Siri-like smartness to the platform
<http://bit.ly/xiQHUC>

Holograms, anyone?

Holoxica showcased its new prototype holographic display at CES
<http://bit.ly/zU8qnr>

LETTER OF THE MONTH

✉ I have been a Digit subscriber for past 2 years. The other day I was reading an international science magazine and was shocked that it had so much information about science & technology. It had topics such as a robot revealing pyramid secrets, dark matter hunt going underground, 21st century additions, the secrets of Stonehenge, what number is infinity plus one? Why don't we use desalination technology to provide drinking water? How to stop procrastinating? How do you generate electricity from waves?, etc. It's filled with computer related stuff too.

Your magazine says "Digit - your technology navigator". In the Jan 2012 issue you have given articles about trends on security, flexible displays, world beyond 1080p, online shopping, etc. These articles are all based on a general computer technology. Seems like you guys have exaggerated it just to fill blank spaces. There is a huge quantity but no quality. The magazine says "Digit - your technology navigator" but you are focusing only on the computer part of technology. Tech is related to lot of things. Reviews of processors, motherboards, keyboards and cameras are published every month just to fill sheets. I liked just one article: Higgs and Seek and the Fast Track.

While writing the letter I literally had to search the magazine to give an example about a good article. You may think it's just one person's opinion but I've asked a lot of people who say that Digit is starting to loose it's standards.

I hope you take this as a suggestion rather than a complaint. You guys need to research more before publishing. For the expensive Rs150 you charge customers expect a lot of things may be a survey or feedback may help.

Shashank Keshava

■ Thank you for your mail. Yes we are a little more focussed on the computer technology side of things than the

general sciences. Although we do write articles about science in every issue, and some issues might contain more such articles than usual (our last anniversary issue, for example), we cannot forget that our roots are PC tech.

Digit is more about de-mystifying technology for regular folks, and helping the geeky-at-heart to get a leg-up in the world of tech. Ours is a community of doers, and we aim to please that community with the articles we write. The tests you speak of are rigorously conducted every month to let readers know that not all products launched in the market are deserving, and we ensure that our readers save their money by buying only deserving products. They're not "space fillers", and perhaps the most significant contributor to why more people read Digit than all other tech magazines combined.

While other magazines write articles about the stuff robots are doing across the world, Digit gave out Fast Track to help our readers build their own robot. While every mag/site will talk about going green, and talk about environmental issues, we went out and bought seeds, and encouraged our readers to plant them and grow trees, and even though only hundreds of readers (from lakhs) did that, that's several hundred new trees that wouldn't have existed in the normal course of things. Like I said, doers.

I wish I could tell you that we will change, and try and be more like the magazines you look up to, but I cannot, because that would be letting down the lakhs of other readers who look up to us for doing what we do best. We will obviously try and improve quality, that's something we do on a daily basis - strive to improve. However, we will not become a science magazine, and will stay focused on the technology aspect, and continue in the spirit of teaching people to achieve (rather than just talk about) what's important.

Robert

These were some of my views towards Digit. I hope you would consider my suggestions.

Vaibhav Jain

■ Thanks for writing in with your feedback on Digit, Vaibhav. We always welcome constructive criticism, that's how we understand what our readers want and helps us make changes for the betterment of the magazine. We take pride in our magazine's design and content and the dash of humour scattered all over, it helps define Digit's personality to our readers. We promise to try and do something about the placement of advertisements in the future issues.

Fast Tracks are an integral part of the Digit experience, and they've been a resounding hit among our readers right from when they were debuted. Thanks for suggesting future topics, we will definitely look into them.

We go to great lengths to ensure our monthly DVD's content is fresh, interesting and diverse, so all of our readers can find something interesting there. It's unfortunate to learn you can't play the DVDs sometimes, please make sure you email us with any problems you face on the following address: dvd@thinkdigit.com. We will make sure such issues don't occur in the future.

We are trying very hard to ensure all our readers, including the ones who subscribe and the ones who don't, get the magazine on the 1st of every month, be it on the newstand or delivered to your doorstep. However, it's a challenge and despite our best efforts, circumstances beyond our control can hinder the timely delivery of magazines to all of you. But rest assured, we try our best to avoid any bottlenecks when it comes to getting the magazine out on time every month.

Nimish

CORRIGENDUM

In the Tablet comparison test last month, we wrongly listed some features of ViewSonic's ViewPad. The device has an HDMI-out and 4 GB of storage. We apologise to ViewSonic and our readers for this error.